



dark abdomen contains
most of the animal's
vital internal organs

orange-red
patella, or knee

palps are used for
feeling, groping prey,
and transferring
sperm to the female

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The head and thorax are fused into one body part, which carries the legs and mouthparts. The abdomen has openings for breathing and reproduction, and two pairs of spinnerets at the rear.

^ HAIRY WEAPONS
Like many tropical American tarantulas, this spider defends itself by rubbing its hind legs against its abdomen to release the barbed, stinging hairs that grow there. These urticating hairs are tiny and light, and designed to float in a cloud around a predator's face, getting in its eyes, nose, and mouth. They cause intense irritation when lodged in skin.